Where It Went (from Almost, Maine)

By John Cariani

Lights up on Phil and Marci, who have just been ice-skating on Echo Pond in Almost, Maine. They are undoing their skates, putting on their boots/shoes. Phil has hockey skates; Marci has figure skates. Marci has one shoe on, one skate on. (Marci should be wearing a winter shoe – like an L.L. Bean hunting shoe, or a suede-like winter shoe – not a boot.)

"// and >" indicates an overlap of lines

INTRODUCTION

ACTRESS: *"He is never there for me when I need him the most."*
ACTOR: *"She's angry all the time, but she won't tell me why."*
ACTRESS: *"We're like ships passing in the night, he goes his way and I go mine."*
ACTOR: *When you feel lonely within your marriage, you don't feel like you're part of anything bigger than yourself.*
ACTRESS: *You feel alone, and there is no "we," only you and your spouse, completely separate entities.*
ACTOR: *You may or may not seem to be a happy couple to others,*
ACTRESS: *and you may or may not be able to keep a united front for the kids.*
ACTOR: *Either way, when it is just you and your spouse talking to each other, you don't feel close, connected, secure or safe.*
ACTRESS: *And it starts so slowly that by the time you realize the marriage is in trouble,*
ACTOR: *the other shoe has already dropped.*
TOGETHER: *Where It Went from Almost, Main by John Cariani*

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PHIL: It still feels like you're mad.

MARCI: *(Undoing her skate.)* I'm not mad, / / I just said I wish >

PHIL: But you were, you *are*, >

MARCI: you'd pay more attention lately.

PHIL: you're mad.

MARCI: I'm not mad! I was having fun, I thought. I had fun tonight. Did you?

PHIL: Yeah.

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MARCI: Good. *(Smiles, continues to undo her skates; is puzzled by something. Beat.)*

PHIL: *(Continuing his defense.)* I mean, Chad called me in to the mill. I had to work.

MARCI: *(Looking for something.)* I'm not mad at you, Phil, you had to work, / / I get it.

PHIL: I did!

MARCI: *(Now actively looking for something.)* Phil, where's my shoe?

PHIL: What?

MARCI: Where's my shoe, I can't find it.

PHIL: Well, it's gotta be here . . .

MARCI: Where is it?!? *(They look for her shoe. Beat.)* Is this you being funny?

PHIL: No.

MARCI: 'Cause it's not funny. >

PHIL: I –

MARCI: It's cold out here!

PHIL: Well, you're the one that wanted to go skating!

MARCI: Phil!

PHIL: *(Angry – a bit of an explosion.)* We'll find it! It's gotta be here! *(Beat.)*

MARCI: I'm not mad. I was never mad. *(Re-lacing her skate – too cold for stocking feet. Beat.)* I was disappointed. But now I'm / / done.

PHIL: Marce! –

MARCI: I had fun tonight! Skating! I thought it would be fun!, >

PHIL: It *was* . . .

MARCI: forget all the . . . stuff. Get us away from the kids, get us back to where we used to be. We went skating . . . first time you kissed me, on a Friday night just like this one. 'Member? Right here . . . *(She touches Phil in some way – maybe rubs his back.)* Echo Pond **PHIL:** *(Subtly/subconsciously shaking off Marci's touch.)* I know where we are, where the heck is your shoe? *(Going to look for it.)* Maybe

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it's – maybe it's in the car. Did you -- . . . Where'd you put your skates on, out here or in the car? *(We hear him open the doors and trunk of the car.)*

MARCI: *(Dealing with the fact that Phil shrugged her off.)* I put them on with you. Right here. *(Beat. She looks to the sky for answers.)*

PHIL: *(Returning.)* Well, it's / / not in the car –

MARCI: *(She sees a shooting star.)* Oh-oh-oh!!! Shooting star, shooting star! *(She closes her eyes, and makes a wish.)*

PHIL: Wha -- / / Where, where?!? *(He looks for it).*

MARCI: *(Eyes closed.)* Shh!! I'm wishing, I'm wishing!

PHIL: *(Keeps looking, and then:)* Oh, I missed it.

MARCI: *(Just looks at him.)* Yeah, you did.

PHIL: What's that supposed to mean?

MARCI: *(Finishes re-lacing her skate, eventually gets up to look for her shoe.)* Nothing – it's just . . . not really all that surprising >

PHIL: What?

MARCI: that you didn't see it.

PHIL: What?

MARCI: The shooting star.

PHIL: Why?

MARCI: You don't pay attention, Phil. *(Beat.)*

PHIL: See, when you say things like that, I feel like you're still mad.

MARCI: I'm not.

PHIL: Marce –

MARCI: I wasn't mad. *(Frustrated about a lot more than her missing shoe.)* *WHERE* is my *shoe*?!?! Gosh, maybe it *is* in the car. *(Going offstage, to the car, to look for her other shoe.)* I mean, >

PHIL: It's not in the car . . .

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MARCI: I have one shoe on already. *(From off.)* I *know* I didn't put my skates on in the car, 'cause the shoe I have on was out there. I changed out there, didn't I? With you? Phil? *(Phil doesn't answer. He is trying to sort out what's going on with him, his wife. He's sad. From off:)* Phil? I put my shoes right next to yours, after we put our skates on, but it's not . . . there . . . This is the weirdest thing. *(Returning.)* It's not in the car, I mean, I'm not gonna put one skate on in the car, the other one on out here – *(Sees how sad Phil is.)* What's wrong?

PHIL: *(Covering.)* Huh? Oh. I'm . . . making a wish of my own. On a regular one.

MARCI: Oh.

PHIL: Wanna wish on it with me?

MARCI: Yeah. Yeah, that'd be nice. Which one?

PHIL: Umm . . . see Hedgehog Mountain?

MARCI: Uh-huh.

PHIL: Straight up, right above it.

MARCI: The bright one?

PHIL: Yeah.

MARCI: That one?

PHIL: Yeah.

MARCI: Right there?

PHIL: Yeah.

MARCI: Phil . . .

PHIL: Yeah?

MARCI: That's a planet.

PHIL: What?

MARCI: That's a planet. You're wishing on a planet.

PHIL: That's a -- ?

MARCI: Yeah, >

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PHIL: Well, how do you know?

MARCI: and it's *(She sings.)* " . . . when you wish upon a *star*," not " . . . when you wish upon a *planet* / / or *Saturn* – "

PHIL: I know, I know! How do you know?

MARCI: Said on the weather, Phil. Saturn's the brightest object in the sky this month. It'll be sitting right above Hedgehog Mountain over the next bunch of weeks. They've been sayin' it on the weather all week. And your wish is never gonna come true if you're wishing on a planet.

PHIL: Well –

MARCI: You gotta pay attention.

PHIL: Why do you keep sayin' that?

MARCI: What?

PHIL: That I gotta pay attention?

MARCI: 'Cause you don't.

PHIL: What are you talkin' about? –

MARCI: Phil . . . Happy Anniversary. *(Beat.)*

PHIL: Huh?

MARCI: Happy Anniversary. That's what I'm talkin' about. *(Beat.)*

PHIL: I'm -- . *(Can't quite say he's sorry. Beat. Then, instead of apologizing:)* I knew you were mad.

MARCI: I'm not mad, / / Phil!

PHIL: You're mad at me, and pretty soon, outta nowhere, it's gonna get ugly. >

MARCI: Phil, I'm not mad, I'm –

PHIL: I mean, Marce: I'm *sorry*!! I know I missed some things, but I gotta work! I gotta take a double when Chad needs me at the mill! He's helpin' me – *us* – out, you know, / / offering me the overtime!

MARCI: I know, I know –

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PHIL: No, you *don't* know: Me workin' is for *us*, and the kids, and it's a lot sometimes, and it messes me up!

MARCI: Phil! I'm not mad about you workin'. You gotta work. I understand that. What I don't understand is why I'm lonely, Phil. I got a husband and a coupla great kids. And I'm lonely. *(Beat.)* You just -- . . . you don't pay attention anymore. You go away. And I don't know where you go, but you go somewhere where you can't pay attention and you forget your son's first hockey game and / / you forget Missy's birthday and >

PHIL: Hockey equipment costs money!

MARCI: you forget your *anniversary*! I mean, I brought you here hoping you'd remember about us. But you didn't. And that makes me so mad I don't know what to do anymore . . . *(Beat.)*

PHIL: You *lie*.

MARCI: What?

PHIL: You lie so bad.

MARCI: What?

PHIL: You're mad at me. But you don't *tell* me – even when I ask you over and over –

MARCI: Because *you* wouldn't / / pay attention if I *did* tell you –

PHIL: No! No! No! Because *you* don't know how to tell me what you feel like about me, so I never know where I am, where I stand! Maybe that's why I go away! So I can know where I am for a second! And you know what, it's lonely there too where I go. And you sent me there. You went away a long time before I did. And now all's you do is lie.

MARCI: I don't lie!

PHIL: *(Furious.)* Yes you do! You say you're not mad, but you're mad! You say you have fun, but you didn't! You didn't have fun tonight, did you?

MARCI: No.

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PHIL: But you kept sayin' you did.

MARCI: I didn't. I didn't have fun, Phil. I don't have fun with you anymore. *(Beat.)* Did you?

PHIL: No. I had a rotten, lousy time. *(Beat.)*

MARCI: Well, then . . . *(Little beat.)* what are we doin'? What are we waiting for?

(Beat. And then . . . a shoe that looks exactly like Marci's other shoe drops from the sky, right between Marci and Phil. Beat. Marci and Phil survey the sky, trying to figure out what just happened. Music. Phil retrieves the shoe and gives it to Marci, who puts it on. Marci gets up. She then takes the car keys out of her pocket, exits, and we hear her start the car and drive away. Phil is alone. A shooting star cuts across the night sky on the field of stars. Phil sees it. Lights fade.

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AWARD HISTORY

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